

ACTIVITIES AND FUNCTIONS OF GOVERNMENT STATISTICAL DEPARTMENTS

Department of Economics & Statistics, Government of Kerala, and
Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation, Government of India

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1. Introduction

Statistics plays an important role in planning, policy formulation, resource allocation and evaluation of development programmes. In India, official statistics are produced through a coordinated system involving the Central Government and State Governments. At the State level, the Department of Economics & Statistics (DES), Government of Kerala, functions as the nodal agency for collecting, compiling, analysing, interpreting and disseminating statistical information related to Kerala's economy. At the national level, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) is the nodal ministry responsible for the planned and organized development of the national statistical system.

2. Department of Economics & Statistics, Kerala

The Department of Economics & Statistics supports evidence-based planning in Kerala by generating statistical information on several sectors. Its activities include population and vital statistics, agriculture, industry, prices, state income, labour, housing, infrastructure, environment and gender statistics. The department also functions as the State Agricultural Statistics Authority and is responsible for collecting and estimating agricultural statistics.

An important activity of the department is conducting surveys and studies on contemporary socio-economic issues. These surveys help identify data gaps and provide information required for policy formulation and evaluation. The department also conducts ad-hoc surveys and studies required for estimating the Gross State Domestic Product and related economic indicators.

The department participates in major census and statistical activities and works in coordination with national statistical organisations. It publishes statistical reports, bulletins,

analytical studies and other datasets through its official portal. Recent activities include surveys related to agriculture, labour and unincorporated enterprises, as well as the publication of price, industrial production and other economic statistics.

3. Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation, India

At the national level, MoSPI coordinates statistical activities among Central Ministries, State Governments and Union Territories. It develops standards, concepts, classifications and methodologies for official statistics and works to improve the quality, availability and timely dissemination of data.

MoSPI conducts and coordinates major socio-economic surveys such as the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE), Multiple Indicator Survey and other specialised surveys. It also produces important national economic indicators, including National Accounts Statistics, the Index of Industrial Production and Consumer Price related statistics.

Another important responsibility is monitoring progress towards the Sustainable Development Goals through the National Indicator Framework. Through its Programme Implementation wing, MoSPI also monitors selected Central Sector Projects and the implementation of the Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme.

4. Conclusion

The statistical systems of Kerala and India provide the data required for evidence-based governance and development planning. Kerala DES focuses on generating reliable statistics at the State level, while MoSPI provides national coordination, standards, surveys and important economic and social indicators. Together, these organisations demonstrate how statistical methods transform raw data into useful information for government decision-making. For students of statistics, data science and artificial intelligence, understanding these activities is particularly important because modern decision-making increasingly depends on reliable data, statistical analysis and data-driven models.

References

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